

Aware of dangers, on and off duty, the Queen knew her every move was watched. Naturally shy, this made her more wary.

At home, with people she knew well, she could be herself. She could tell funny stories about things going wrong on her visits, such as a hat blowing off, a flower bouquet dropped, or a driver getting lost. Philip could be impatient, and although Elizabeth too had a temper, she seldom lost it. People found her kind and understanding, and it was known that she could find it hard to say “no.”



However, it was in the countryside that Elizabeth was at her most relaxed. Now a racehorse owner as well as a rider, she could often be found at the stables tending her horses. She read the racing news closely, along with the daily papers.

